
Deleted tweets on Darializa Avila Chevalier's account had favorable references to communist leaders and Marxism | CNN Politics

Published by

Andrew Kaczynski

Estimated reading time

3 min

Added on

2026-06-30

Address

<https://edition.cnn.com/2026/06/29/politics/darializa-avila-chevalier-communism-tweets>

Deleted tweets on Darializa Avila Chevalier's account had favorable references to communist leaders and Marxism | CNN Politics

Darializa Avila Chevalier, the Democratic congressional nominee endorsed by New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani, who ousted longtime Rep. Adriano Espaillat in Tuesday's primary, maintained a since-deleted Twitter account with repeated sympathetic references to communism, Marxist ideology and Soviet figures, including Vladimir Lenin.

Avila Chevalier, a sociology PhD student whose victory sent shockwaves throughout the Democratic establishment, has been under fire for a since-deleted Twitter account, previously [reported](#) by CNN, that included [phrases such](#) as "seize the means of production," along with calls to abolish police, prisons and borders. Other [controversial tweets](#) include one that said Black and Arab men are both "Fetishizing ugly colonizer women" and another [that described wiping](#) her dirty hands on the American flag in lieu of a napkin.

As an undergraduate, Avila Chevalier attended Columbia University, [where she organized](#) with Students for Justice in Palestine, and after graduation became involved in pro-Palestinian campus protests over Israel's war in Gaza. She also [attended](#) a controversial October 8, 2023, pro-Palestinian rally in Times Square — one day after Hamas' attack on Israel — that featured speeches and rhetoric praising the attack.

She previously told CNN, "I have grown considerably in the years since these tweets, and I am focused on our community and our community's future."

On Thursday, President Donald Trump accused Avila Chevalier of being a communist, a charge that she [said](#) she wouldn't respond to while on MSNOW, saying, "I won't be reactive."

A further review of Avila Chevalier's archived Twitter account from 2020-2022 found repeated references to communism and Marxist ideology. The account, "Darializabonet," appears to have been deleted in June 2022.

The account's bio read [in 2020](#), "how communist of you." Archived posts and retweets during this timeframe included a recommendation [that](#) Karl Marx's *Capital* was an "essential must-read," a [complaint](#) that public libraries did not carry enough Marxist literature by Lenin and other revolutionary writers, and a [retweet](#) from a Communist-identifying account [lamenting](#) that bookstore "banned books" displays did not include *The Complete Works of J. V. Stalin*.

One archived retweet from [2020 quoted](#) Assata Shakur, the former Black Liberation Army member who, in 1977, was convicted in the murder of a New Jersey state trooper before later escaping prison and fleeing to Cuba. In the quote, Shakur said she "preferred Ho Chi Minh, Kim Il Sung, Che, or Fidel (Castro)" before studying Marx and Lenin because the two "white dudes" had made contributions to "revolutionary struggle" that were "too great to be ignored."

In April 2020, Avila Chevalier shared a post lamenting that people wouldn't accept communism over a lack of varieties of soup — a reference to the critique that the political system leads to fewer consumer choices.

"I just cannot get over the fact that the universe has foisted upon us the perfect illustration of literally every failing of capitalism and people are still like we can't be communists cuz there won't be enough types of soup," the [post she retweeted](#) read.

Other posts critiqued or joked about popular culture she viewed as anti-communist.

In one post, Avila Chevalier [described](#) the animated film *Anastasia* as "an explicitly anti-USSR kid's movie," and in [another](#) post [she linked to she wrote](#): "Time for me to once again sympathize with the people the Bolsheviks put in the blender for like 90 min ?."

Avila Chevalier was responding to a viral false claim that Disney had removed *Anastasia* from Disney+ streaming service because it was anti-Russia after the invasion of Ukraine.

In another post, Avila Chevalier [joked](#) that Sheryl Crow's hit song *Soak Up the Sun* was "bootstrap capitalist propaganda" after noticing it opens with the lyric "my friend the communist," quipping that the character was "apparently also a bad organizer lol."

[Another 2020 retweet](#) argued for democratic worker control of wealth, dismissing ideological labels by concluding: "You can call that communism, you can call it socialism, you can call it pancakes."

And previously, CNN had surfaced [an April 2020 post](#) where Avila-Chevalier said that while most of the political theory she had read was communist, "the pyromania associated with anarchism is very intriguing to me," punctuating the remark with a laughing emoji.

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

Please open [an issue](#) if you have trouble with the display of this E-Book on your device.